

Where does electricity come from?

Most of the electricity people use in their homes comes from a power plant. The electricity travels along power lines to our homes, where we use it for cooking, heating, lighting, and running appliances like televisions.

3 On the move

The high-voltage electricity is carried along power lines supported by huge towers.

2 Step up

The electricity travels to a "step-up" substation, which increases the electricity's voltage (pressure that pushes it along). This makes it easier to move and wastes less energy.

1 Power plant

At most power plants, fossil fuels such as coal, oil, or gas are burned to heat water to make steam. This steam turns a wheel called a turbine to make electricity.

Fossil fuels are formed underground from the remains of ancient plants and animals.

